

● MEDIUM

● EXPRESSION OF IDEAS

● ANSWER KEY

Rhetorical Synthesis

10

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ANSWER KEY · SAT QUESTION BANK

2026-05-29

Q1**A**

- A. Ida Tarbell not only interviewed Standard Oil executives, oil industry workers, and public officials but also examined thousands of pages of the company's internal communications.

Choice A is the best answer. It describes Tarbell's investigation and the lengths she went to complete it.

Choice B is incorrect. This choice doesn't describe how thorough Tarbell was. Instead, it gives a biographical sketch. Choice C is incorrect. This choice doesn't describe how thorough Tarbell was. Tarbell didn't only conduct interviews—she also “examined thousands of pages of the company's internal communications.” Choice D is incorrect. This choice doesn't describe how thorough Tarbell was. It describes her book but doesn't include anything about her investigation.

Q2**B**

- B. To find out how many medical schools have guidelines about student social media use, Terry Kind and her team examined the student policies of 132 medical schools.

Choice B is the best answer. The sentence effectively emphasizes Kind's methodology: examining the student policies of 132 medical schools for guidelines about student social media use.

Choice A is incorrect. The sentence specifies how many medical schools' student policies are available online; it doesn't emphasize the study's methodology. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence emphasizes the study's results, not the study's methodology. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence emphasizes the aim of the study, not the study's methodology.

Q3

A

- A. Leaving in 1914 for Antarctica, Shackleton and his crew underwent many harrowing sea-ice adventures, including losing their ship in 1915, before being rescued in 1916.
-

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence provides a historical overview of the Shackleton expedition, noting that the explorers left for Antarctica in 1914, lost their ship in 1915, and were rescued in 1916.

Choice B is incorrect. The sentence misrepresents information from the notes; Shackleton and his crew were themselves rescued in 1916—they weren't rescuing others. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence provides examples of works and discoveries inspired by the expedition; it doesn't provide an overview of the expedition itself. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence provides examples of works made about the expedition; it doesn't provide an overview of the expedition itself.

Q4

D

- D. In a 2021 study, Chinsamy-Turan determined that pterosaur jawbones located in the Sahara Desert had few growth lines relative to the bones of fully grown pterosaurs and thus belonged to juveniles.
-

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence presents both the study and its findings, noting the study's date and the researcher's name as well as describing what the researcher determined about the jawbones and how she determined it.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence describes the study and the researcher's initial assessment, it doesn't present the study's findings. Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence describes the study and its focus, it doesn't present the study's findings or the name of the researcher who conducted it. Choice C is incorrect. While the sentence mentions the study's methodology and provides information about pterosaurs, it doesn't present the study's findings.

Q5

D

- D. Rai's approach substitutes a natural, plant-based substance for the hazardous chemicals that manufacturers have traditionally used.
-

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence emphasizes a difference between the two approaches to dyeing blue jeans, noting that Rai's approach uses a natural, plant-based substance in place of hazardous chemicals.

Choice A is incorrect. The sentence emphasizes a similarity between the dyes used in the two approaches, noting that the dyes contain the same ingredient; it doesn't emphasize a difference between the two approaches to dyeing blue jeans. Choice B is incorrect. The sentence explains what nanocellulose is; it doesn't emphasize a difference between the two approaches to dyeing blue jeans. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence explains the traditional approach to dyeing blue jeans; it doesn't emphasize a difference between the traditional approach and Rai's approach.

Q6

A

- A. In 1037 CE, al-Biruni published his theory that a large landmass existed west of Europe and east of Asia.
-

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence specifies when al-Biruni published his landmass theory, indicating that it was published in the year 1037 CE.

Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence notes that al-Biruni published a landmass theory, it doesn't specify when the theory was published. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence identifies al-Biruni as a scholar of Earth's physical features; it doesn't specify when he published his landmass theory. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence describes al-Biruni's landmass theory; it doesn't specify when the theory was published.

Q7

B

- B. Greenland's glaciers and icebergs both melt during the year, contributing to rising sea levels.
-

Choice B is the best answer. The sentence emphasizes a similarity between glaciers and icebergs in Greenland, noting that both melt and thereby contribute to rising sea levels.

Choice A is incorrect. The sentence provides information about the melting rate of icebergs in Greenland; it doesn't emphasize a similarity between glaciers and icebergs in Greenland. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence emphasizes a difference between glaciers and icebergs in Greenland, noting that their melting rates depend on different factors; it doesn't emphasize a similarity. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence explains the conditions under which glaciers in Greenland melt; it doesn't emphasize a similarity between glaciers and icebergs in Greenland.

Q8

B

- B. The A:shiwi A:wan Museum and Heritage Center has served the Pueblo of Zuni since 1992.
-

Choice B is the best answer. This choice effectively uses information from the notes to emphasize how long the museum has existed. It says that the museum has existed since 1992.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice doesn't emphasize how long the museum has existed. It doesn't say when the museum was founded. Choice C is incorrect. This choice doesn't emphasize how long the museum has existed. It doesn't say the exact date of the museum's founding. Rather, it emphasizes the museum's mission. Choice D is incorrect. This choice doesn't emphasize how long the museum has existed. It doesn't say when the museum was founded.

Q9

D

- D. The lines of the poem *Meghadūta* use a pattern of long and short syllables, whereas *Widsith*'s lines use a pattern of repeated sounds.
-

Choice D is the best answer. Noting that *Meghadūta* uses a pattern of long and short syllables in its lines (quantitative meter) and *Widsith* uses a pattern of repeated sounds in its lines (alliterative meter), and signaling a contrast with “whereas,” the sentence emphasizes a difference between the meters of the two poems.

Choice A is incorrect. The sentence indicates that the two poems were written in different languages; it doesn't emphasize a difference between the meters of the two poems. Choice B is incorrect. The sentence mentions the meters of the two poems but misrepresents information from the notes; the overall definition of a meter (the rhythmic structure or pattern of accents in a poem's lines) applies to both alliterative and quantitative meters, not just quantitative. Choice C is incorrect. While the sentence emphasizes a difference between the meters of the two poems, it misrepresents information from the notes; *Widsith* uses an alliterative meter, which is structured by a pattern of repeated sounds, not a pattern of long and short syllables.

Q10

D

- D. Redesigning a poorly designed city flag can create a meaningful symbol of civic pride, as was the case when Pocatello redesigned its original flag to better represent its geography and civic priorities.
-

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence makes and supports a generalization about the effect of redesigning a city flag, noting that redesigning a city flag can create a meaningful symbol of civic pride, as was the case when the city of Pocatello redesigned its flag.

Choice A is incorrect because the sentence explains that many US cities have redesigned their flags and provides an example; it doesn't make and support a generalization about the effect of redesigning a city flag. Choice B is incorrect because the sentence provides an example of a city that redesigned its flag; it doesn't make and support a generalization about the effect of redesigning a city flag. Choice C is incorrect because the sentence emphasizes why the flag of Pocatello was redesigned; it doesn't make and support a generalization about the effect of redesigning a city flag.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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